

FOUR QUESTIONS · FIFTEEN MINUTES · ONE HONEST CUP OF COFFEE

AI readiness checklist for school leaders

AI use in your building already happened; the only question is whether the adults are prepared.

CHECK 1 Do your staff know the one hard rule? ~4 min

The rule: no student personally identifiable information goes into a public AI tool, ever. Ask three teachers what the school's AI privacy rule is. Three different answers, or three blank looks, is your finding. It's also the cheapest fix on this page: the rule can be taught to a full staff in ten minutes.

☐ Three teachers gave me the same answer, and it was the right one

CHECK 2 Is there an interim stance in writing? ~4 min

Stance, not policy: one page saying what staff may do, the one hard rule, who to ask, and when you'll revisit. If you can't put your hands on it right now, it doesn't exist.

☐ A written stance exists and staff know where it lives

CHECK 3 Who is your natural AI lead? ~3 min

Every building already has one: the respected peer colleagues already ask "how did you make that?" Write down a name (a department head will know within seconds if you can't). A little release time and public backing turn that name into your facilitator.

☐ I have a name written down · _____

CHECK 4 Does your PD plan include hands-on time? ~4 min

Was there a block where every teacher had a device open and actually tried something, with help in the room? A lecture changes nothing: protect a hands-on lab block and schedule short follow-ups so the learning survives contact with October.

☐ Our plan protects hands-on time and includes follow-ups

Scoring: four yeses, you're ahead of most buildings. Two or three: start with Check 1; privacy risk is live today. Zero or one: better to know now than after an incident.